PROactive PRONUNCIATION

V vs. W Minimal Pair Sentences

/w/ and /v/ are oftentimes confused. The /w/ is produced when the lips are in a rounded position, similar to “oooo." The /v/, on the other hand, includes biting the lower lip. Both are voiced. Try to compare the difference in pronunciation between these sounds in the words below. Look in the mirror to see how the shape of your lips for /w/ is round and how your upper teeth should be visible for the /v/ sound.

You should be very wary of the shadows
We need a second letter “v” to spell the word savvy
This veil makes me look as big as a whale
The blood pressure in my vein is beginning to wane
I went to look at the vent on the floor
That verse was worse than the first verse
She was well versed in making up the worst type of insults
When I went out west, I always wore a vest
The vet got wet in the rain
The wicks of these candles smell like Vicks Vaporub
I will vie for your attention, although I don’t know why
The smell was so vile while the window was shut
The grapes of the vine create the most wonderful wine
Wally was great at volleyball
My vows are going to wow her
Everyone will join in singing the worst verse
Whenever you play the violin, I smile
Would you like to try my very wonderful vitamin water?
West Virginia is where I’d love to travel the most
I wonder if this wave of violence will be over soon
Whatever you want to do, I’ll join you
We will invent new software
Where is the Volkswagen now?
You did very wonderful work today, Ivan